



Projectors		Projectors Above Rs 1 Lakh			
Brand Model	Epson EMP 1715	Epson EMP-1815	NEC LT380	NEC NP1150G	Sony VPL-CX125
Price (Rs)	Rs 1,16,600	Rs 1,42,000	Rs 1,24,000	Rs 1,58,000	Rs 1,39,900
Plus (+)	Well Built	Well Built	Great Performance	Great Connectivity	Well Built
Minus (-)	Lacks Performance	Very Expensive	Slightly Overpriced	Bulky and Heavy	Very Bulky
Grand Totals (Out of 100)	71.06	75.61	83.90	81.15	73.89
Features (Out of 45)	33.12	36.43	40.17	37.87	31.32
Performance (Out of 55)	37.94	39.19	43.73	43.29	42.57
Features					
Projection System (DLP / LCD / LCOS / CRT)	LCD	LCD	LCD	LCD	LCD
Native Resolution (Pixels)	1024 x 768	1024 x 768	1024 x 768	1024 x 768	1024 x 768
Brightness (ANSI Lumens)	2700 lumens	3500 lumens	3000 lumens	3700 lumens	3000 lumens
Contrast Ratio	400:1	500:1	600:1	600:1	650:1
Optical Zoom (Y / N)	✗ / 1.2x	✗ / 1.6x	✓ / 1.2x	✓ / 1.2x	✗ / 1.16x
Image Size (Max - Min) (Inches)	30 - 300 inches	30 - 300 inches	21 - 300 inches	30 - 500 inches	40 - 300 inches
Throw Distance (Min - Max metres)	1 - 12.1 metres	0.8 - 14.7 metres	0.53 7.62 metres	0.76 - 12.7 metres	1.4 - 9.1 metres
Lamp (Hours) (Normal / Eco mode)	2000 / 3000 hrs	2500 / 3000 hrs	2000 / 3000 hrs	2000 / 3000 hrs	2000 / 3000 hrs
Horizontal Frequency (Khz)	15 - 92 KHz	15 - 99 KHz	15 - 100 KHz	15 - 108 KHz	19 - 92 KHz
Vertical Scan Rate (Hz)	50 - 85 Hz	50 - 120 Hz	48 - 120 Hz	48 - 120 Hz	48 - 92 Hz
Video Input (S-video, Composite, Component, D-Sub, DVI, HDMI)	✓ / ✓ / ✗ / ✓ / ✗ / ✗	✓ / ✓ / ✗ / ✓ / ✓ / ✗	✓ / ✓ / ✓ / ✓ / ✓ / ✗	✓ / ✓ / ✓ / ✓ / ✓ / ✗	✓ / ✓ / ✗ / ✓ / ✗ / ✗
USB Connectivity (Y / N)	✓	✓	✓	✓	✗
Audio Inputs (PC Stereo, RCA L/R) / Speakers (Mono / Stereo)	✓ , ✗ / Mono	✓ , ✓ / Mono	✓ , ✓ / Mono	✓ , ✓ / Stereo	✓ , ✗ / Mono
PC Control Terminal (Y / N)	✓	✓	✓	✓	✓
Maximum Power Consumption	228 watts	286 watts	292 watts	460 watts	285 watts
Rated Noise (dB) (Max)	38 dB	36 dB	35 dB	33 dB	32 dB
Weight (kgs)	1.7 kgs	3.1 kgs	3.5 kgs	7.3 kgs	4.1 kgs
OSD Menu layout and Usability (Scale of 10)	8	7.5	8.25	8.5	9
Digital Keystone	✓ (Vertical Only)	✓	✓	✓	✓
Remote Control	✓	✓	✓	✓	✓
Performance					
Display Mate Video Edition (Scale Of 10)					
Sharpness And Resolution					
Horizontal / Vertical Bar Resolution	6.5 / 6.5	6.75 / 6.75	7.5 / 7.5	7.75 / 7.5	7.5 / 7.5
Corner Resolution	6.75	7	7.5	7.75	7.5
Focus / Fine Focus / Diagonal Focus Matrix	6.5 / 6.5 / 6.5	7 / 7 / 7	7.5 / 7.5 / 7.5	7.5 / 7.5 / 7.75	7 / 7 / 7
Moire Pattern	6.5	6	7.25	8	6.75
Screen Pixel Resolution	7	7.75	7.25	7.75	7.5
Color And Gray Scale Tests					
Streaking And Ghosting / Colour Streaking	6.5 / 6.5	7 / 7.25	7.5 / 7.5	7.5 / 7.5	7 / 7
16-intensity Levels	7.25	7.75	7.75	7.25	8
White / Black Level Shift	7 / 7	7 / 7	7.5 / 7.5	7.5 / 7.5	6.5 / 6.25
Red / Green / Blue Colour Purity	7.5 / 7.25 / 7	7.75 / 7.5 / 7.75	8 / 7.75 / 7.5	7.25 / 7.75 / 7.5	7.75 / 7.75 / 7.5
Miscellaneous Effects (Scale Of 10)					
Screen Uniformity / Flicker / ANSI Brightness, Contrast	6.75 / 6 / 6.25	7.5 / 7.25 / 7.25	7.75 / 7.25 / 7.25	7.75 / 7 / 7.5	7 / 6.5 / 7
Defocusing, Blooming And Halos	6.5	6.5	7	7	7
Presentation Tests (Scale Of 10)					
Text / Reverse Text Quality (P Mode)	7 / 7	7 / 7.25	8.5 / 7.5	8.25 / 7.5	8 / 7.5
Quality Of Photographs / Animation	7 / 7	8 / 7.5	8.25 / 7.75	8.25 / 8	8 / 7.5
Movie Tests (Scale Of 10)					
Brightness And Contrast / Crispness, Detail	7.25 / 7.25	7.5 / 7.5	8.25 / 8.25	8.25 / 8.5	8 / 8
Game Quality Tests					
F.E.A.R.					
Effects Quality / Sharpness And Detail	7 / 7	7 / 7	7.75 / 8	8 / 8.25	7.75 / 7.75
Crysis					
Effects Quality / Sharpness And Detail	6.75 / 6.25	6.75 / 6	8 / 8.25	8.25 / 8.25	8 / 8
Warranty	2 years	2 years	2 years	2 years	1 year



tor a distinct look, that is both muscular and stylish. PC card connectivity is something we’re seeing for the first time. The *de facto*, (for a high-end projector), USB and RJ45 connects are provided. Component connectivity is another plus for video enthusiasts who usually hate low quality Composite connects. S-Video, VGA and DVI connectivity is also present, and the fully functional and stylishly contoured remote control gives the impression of this being a packed-to-the-gills solution. For PC control, a serial interface has been provided.

This projector trounced DisplayMate and chalked up some scores for which nobody had any criticism. Text quality is sharp, clear and precise with well defined fonts. Movie quality is simply mind-blowing—neck and neck with the VT800, and HD movies are a ton of fun on this projector. Likewise, gaming is immersive, and if you’re a hardcore gamer who wants something feature-rich, then the LT380 is highly recommended. Crysis comes to life with simply amazing detail-ing, colour and contrast.

At Rs 1,24,000, the NEC LT380 is the upper echelon of home entertainment. It’s a more balanced solution than NEC’s own VT800 with an additional connectivity option at the loss of an HDMI port, which at this price point, should be included. Sorry to complain NEC, but you’ve slipped up here.

We can’t recommend the LT380 over its sibling for a home theatre system, as there’s nothing to choose from on the performance front, though there’s a rather large price difference of Rs 30,000 between them.

NEC NP1150G

The colossal NP1150G is being reviewed last, not because it’s the costliest projector on test, but because it is by far the heaviest (7.3 kgs), with no one wanting to heft it out of its packaging! It’s got a mock metallic finish on the sides with piano white plastic on the top part of the body and gray and a glossy white splashed every



where else. Needless to say, it’s huge, but it’s still well shaped. The sheer bulk won’t please many. The body shape is reminiscent of the VT800—only larger. Display Connectivity includes D-Sub, DVI, Composite, Component, S-Video and a (hardly used) five connector BNC digi-

tal coaxial input that’s labelled “For Computer”. These five BNC connects can also be used with Component connectivity. USB and RJ45 connects are also provided. Finally, this projector features *stereo* speakers, and the volume output is pretty impressive for a projector.

DisplayMate was a breeze, with the large NP1150G just warming up to the challenge. It’s got brilliant image quality with photos, animations and presentations looking amazing. Text quality is good, and is only surpassed by the excellent Sharp XR-30X. Fire up a movie, and you can really relax in front of this beauty. With a 3700-lumen brightness rating and a contrast of 600:1, the NP1150G is special when it comes to delivering cinematic-like quality inside your living room, or wherever you choose to place it.

For games, it’s a mixed bag. Sure it was excellent, but there were places when we felt its cheaper siblings, the LT380 and VT800 outdo it. However, for the most, it was a much better performer, and we spent hours playing *Crysis* and *S.T.A.L.K.E.R.* on this one. *F.E.A.R.* comes to life, replete with scary effects, realistic shadows, and some amazing weapon detail-ing. The atmospheric essence of this game is exceptionally well captured.

For its versatility, connectivity options, build quality, and performance, the

NP1150G is an amazing projector. No wonder then, that its price also brings with it the most audible “Ouch!”. At Rs 1,58,000, we figure this beauty is a beast that faces serious threat from its leaner, meaner siblings—but nobody else. If you are intent on coughing up this much dough for a home entertainment system, we advise you to buy one of its cheaper siblings mentioned above, and invest in a better set of surround sound speakers than the ones you have planned. Spend wisely, don’t just spend. ■

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